services'. China does better on virtually all of the other indicators. For instance, on the number of World Heritage sites in the UNESCO listings, India has thirty-seven sites compared to China's fifty-three. In terms of information flows, in 2016–17, India hosted a mere 24,000 foreign students in its tertiary education institutions whereas China hosted 225,000, nine times the Indian number. In people exchanges, as of 2017, India had 5 million regional immigrants (presumably from neighbouring South Asian states such as Bangladesh, Nepal, and Sri Lanka), while China had only 800,000. As far as tourist arrivals is concerned, in 2017 India clocked 5 million arrivals from Asia. China on the other hand clocked 41 million arrivals and ranked first among twenty-five Asian countries.[34] In terms of total tourist arrivals from all over the world, India received 17 million while China received 63 million.[35]

Finally, what about India's and China's relative standing in terms of the attraction to or respect for their political values? Perhaps surprisingly, in 2017, the two were not ranked that far apart. A conventional view is that federal and democratic India's governance effectiveness is low and that centralized and authoritarian China's governance effectiveness is high. In fact, the governance effectiveness index shows that the difference may not be that great: in 2017, India scored in the 57th percentile and ranked 12th while China scored in the 68th percentile and ranked 10th. Neither country scored impressively on 'political stability and absence of violence/terrorism': India ranked 21st with a 17th percentile score and China ranked 15th with a 37th percentile score. Nor were they that far apart on 'civil unrest'.[36] With respect to the quality of their regulatory systems, rule of law, and control of corruption, too, India and China were close. On the other hand, on voice and accountability, which is a measure of the extent to which citizens can express their grievances and demand that officials and politicians are held responsible for their actions (and inactions), India was substantially ahead, averaging a score of roughly 60 (on a scale of 100) over a four-year period while China averaged less than seven.[37]